



“TOP TIPS FOR YOUR TOP CUSTOMERS”

WORKSHOP
WITH DAVID VENTURA

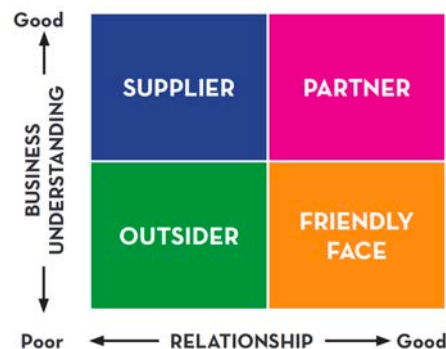


KAMGURU

JUMP AHEAD OF YOUR COMPETITORS

VISTAGE

Work as a 'Partner', not a 'Supplier'



PARTNERSHIP INDICATORS		✓ x
1. They tell you that you are a partner		✓
2. There is clear evidence of added value and ROI		✓
3. You understand their future strategy		x
4. They give you confidential information		✓
5. There are no nasty surprises in the relationship		✓
6. Strong multi-level relationships		x
7. More sales and profit		✓
8. They accept your new products and services		✓
9. Price resistance drops, over time		x
10. They ask for advice, not just on your core offering		✓
11. You have a rolling agreement, not a fixed-term		x
12. Reverse hospitality i.e. they pay!		✓
13. They invite you to shape the tender		✓
14. Joint actions are in place		x
15. They give you referrals		✓
16. Case studies and testimonials		✓
17. Logos appear side by side		✓
18. Tolerance in the event of a problem		✓
19. Feedback is welcomed and dealt with openly		x
20. They bend the rules to accommodate you		x
Totals		13/20

KEY ACCOUNT AUDIT

TODAY	FUTURE
1. Where are we meeting your expectations?	11. How is your business changing and developing?
2. Where are we exceeding your expectations?	12. What pressures will you face from outside the business?
3. Where are we falling short of your expectations?	13. What are your main objectives for the future?
4. What unresolved issues or problems are there?	14. How will you achieve them?
5. How do we compare to other suppliers you use a. In your industry? b. All others	15. How could we help you?
6. How would you sum us up in a sentence?	16. What do you see as being the big issues for our future relationship?
7. How do you measure us?	17. Where could we add more value?
8. Do you see us as a supplier or business partner?	18. What would we have to do to score 10 out of 10?
9. If we were an animal or bird what would we be?	19. Where would you be happy to see us have more of your business?
10. Overall, how many marks out of ten would you give us today?	20. Is there anything else I need to know?

KASH PROFILE

This is a simple, one-page tool that identifies individual training and coaching needs compared to a profile that is common to all account managers. It identifies the knowledge, attitudes, skills and habits needed before results are expected from the account manager, not afterwards.

The green boxes represent “where the account manager needs to be”. Some boxes will go up, some will go down, some will be added and some will be deleted depending upon the strategic direction of your business.

It therefore acts as a very powerful communication tool as it explains what account managers have to be better at, do more of, less of etc.

In some cases, the green boxes may be different for account managers – if there are different KASH requirements for the key accounts.

For example, if an account manager is only working with customers in the chemicals industry then knowledge of this sector would be much higher than for colleagues working in other market sectors.

The red boxes represent where the account manager feels he or she is at the moment.

They are not an assessment by the account manager’s boss – use of the KASH Profile is essentially a self-evaluation exercise.

“Gaps” are not weaknesses – they are, by definition, an open admission of the real situation and a request for help.

Using the example, it is clear that the account manager (Bob) feels that he has 6-7 major areas of personal development. His manager should now work closely with him to address these needs and “close the gaps”.

Remember that Bob also knows how he learns best. A good manager won’t tell Bob he is going on a course to equip him with group presentation skills – the manager would ask Bob for his ideas on how to close the gap down.

If Bob’s solution is to accompany his colleague Claire on two of her presentations during the next three months (rather than sit in a classroom) then this is the solution that will probably work.....for Bob.

The KASH Profile is simple and effective.

In the best cases, it is motivational due to its high levels of participation and ownership.

In the worst cases, when an account manager leaves your company, the green boxes become the recruitment profile for the replacement and will help to shape the content of the advertisement. You win, either way.

Key:

Where the team member needs to be.

Where you feel the team member is today.

Knowledge										
Customer's Strategies and Plans	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Products / Services	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Competitors	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Own Structure, Processes Policies	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Current and Likely Legislation	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Business Planning	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Customer Profile	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Attitudes										
Team Player	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Genuinely Customer Focused	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Well Rounded Outlook	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Positive - Sees Solutions	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Goal Orientation	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Being a Catalyst for Change	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Competitive Instinct	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Strong and Resilient	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Skills										
Research and Planning	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Questioning	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Listening and Summarising	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Presenting Tailored Solutions	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Written Proposals and Letters	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Negotiating	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Internal Marketing / Persuasion	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Organising and Running Customer Meetings	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Networking Skills	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Closing / Gaining Commitment	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Habits										
Punctuality	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Well-Organised	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Appearance	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Ability to Make Things Happen	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10



THE KAM PLAN

NAME OF KEY ACCOUNT	
DATE	
MANAGED BY	
SUPPORTED BY	

“If you know where you are going, you are already half way there”

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INTELLIGENCE

WHAT IS THE CURRENT SWOT SITUATION?

STRENGTHS

WEAKNESSES

OPPORTUNITIES

THREATS

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INTENTIONS

WHAT ARE YOUR PLANS FOR THE FUTURE?

TO ADD VALUE
TO THEM

1.

2.

3.

TO IMPROVE
OUR BUSINESS

1.

2.

3.

TO DEVELOP
RELATIONSHIPS

1.

2.

3.

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IMPLEMENTATION

WHO?**Is Going To Do WHAT?****By WHEN?**

HEALTH CHECK QUESTIONS

1. What is the definition of a key account within your business?
2. Do your people know who they are and why they are “key”?
3. How profitable are they today - do some key accounts need “managing out?”
4. When your salespeople go hunting for new customers do you ask them to look for “quality key accounts” with clear selection criteria or will any old customer do?
5. Today, how many of your key accounts see you as a partner?
6. Which twenty partnership indicators are right for you and what are the scores for each of your top key accounts?
7. In the future, which key accounts would you like to see move to “partner” status?
8. Which key accounts want to preserve a “master and slave” relationship and keep you as a supplier?
9. Is it time to “manage out” some accounts who do not work in the way that you want them to?
10. If your company was arrested and charged with “adding value to key account customers” would there be enough evidence to convict it?
11. How does your company track and measure the value it creates?
12. Are you adding value in the key account’s boardroom? (If not, you are probably “lower down the tree” and just seen as a commodity.)
13. Which aspects of your offering do key accounts truly value and which aspects are they unmoved by?
14. If your business ceased to exist today, what would key account customers miss about it tomorrow?
15. Marks out of ten for your service strategies, your service systems.....and the service skills of your people?
16. How would your colleagues answer the questions above? How would your key accounts answer the questions above?
17. How self-aware are your Key Account Managers today?
18. What ‘energies’ do you have ‘on tap’ in everyday interactions;
 - a. In your team?
 - b. And in the customers team?
19. Where are the KAM team’s ‘blind spots’?
20. What are you buyer’s key motivations and what can you do to support the buyer journey?

WHAT NEXT?

So now what? Well, once you have reflected and discussed some of the points from the session with your colleagues, we hope that you will take action and make things happen.

However, there are some dangers with trying to make things happen quickly i.e. within a month or so. Many of your actions will rely on the interest and commitment of colleagues so why not build a ten-week action plan to cover ten key points. We have seen this format work well in the past.....and we hope that it will also work well for you!

WEEK ONE: Define exactly what the term “key account” means for you and ensure that your people understand which major customers are “key”.....and why.

WEEK TWO: Build your 20 Partnership Indicators and measure your top ten accounts

WEEK THREE: Create compelling, no-brainer testimonials for each of your target markets, following the Value Staircase model of identifiable, quantifiable, auditable and priceless value

WEEK FOUR: Mobilise the senior team and carry out Key Account Audits with main decision makers and decision influencers within your top ten accounts.

WEEK FIVE: Break the customer experience down into bite-size pieces, identify what needs to happen to exceed their expectations and deliver an XX Factor experience for your key accounts

WEEK SIX: Build a one-page Strategic Bridges understanding of each key account’s future strategy – where they are now, where they are going, how they will get there and how you can help and add value along the way.

WEEK SEVEN: Build KASH Profiles to assist the recruitment of new account managers – a one-page profile showing the knowledge, attitudes, skills and habits needed

WEEK EIGHT: Promote key account management as a team sport – diarise team “KAM Days” where account managers are available to support each other on joint visits and presentations.

WEEK NINE: Create KAMplans for each key account – build the storyline that connects Intelligence, Intentions and Implementation

WEEK TEN: Become curious about the motivation and psychological make-up of key decision makers and influencers. It is as simple as ABC. Analyse how they think and behave, build a bridge to their world and then communicate in their language not yours.

KEEP IN TOUCH

Have a look at the www.kamguru.com - there are loads of free downloads and articles available that will help you win, develop and retain key accounts.

And if you have any feedback or questions for us you can track us down via the KAMguru website or the following contact details:

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